

DBS Group (DBSM.SI): First Take: 1Q25 inline robust non-NII offset higher GPs taken; largely affirms 2025 outlook; Buy

DBS posted 1Q25 net profit of S\$2,897mn, -2% yoy/+15% qoq, +2% vs GSe. This quarter's numbers were driven by solid non-NII on strong fee income from wealth management and loan-related fees as well as fees from market trading. Opex also was well-controlled with CIR at 37.5%. NII was inline with GSe with NIMs holding up slightly better at 2.12% (-3bps qoq vs GSe of -4bps) as lower losses from market trading offset the 9bps decline in commercial book NIM. Loan growth was decent at 1.2% qoq. Asset quality remained robust, NPL ratio at 1.10% though credit cost was higher than GSe at 30bps as DBS added to provisions due to the uncertain macro outlook while SPs was at 10bps below guidance of 17-20bps. LLR increased to 137% from 129% at 4Q24. New NPA formation was also lower this quarter (both yoy and qoq). DBS will pay a total of 75cents of dividends for 1Q25 comprising 60cents of ordinary dividend and 15 cents of capital return dividend.

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DBS largely affirms its 2025 outlook with: (1) NII to be slightly above 2024 level (unchanged) based on 3 rate cuts vs 2 previously as expected lower (vs previously slightly lower) NIMs to be offset by balance sheet growth with markets trading to benefit from lower funding cost and funding to be deployed into non-loan assets if loan demand weakens; **(2) Commercial book non-NII growth at mid to high single digit (from high single digit); (3) CIR to be in low 40% (unchanged); (4) SP to normalise to 17-20bps (unchanged) and GP reserves to provide buffer (vs potential GP write backs); (5) Net profit be below 2024 level due to global min tax of 15% (unchanged).**

A decent set of results in our view with robust non-NII, NIMs holding up, and benign asset quality. Provisions were higher but largely understandable given the macro environment and strong PPOP. Furthermore, outlook was largely maintained. We expect DBS shares to hold up well. DBS will be holding a media briefing at 10.30am local time today, followed by an analyst briefing.

Key highlights:

- **Net interest income was inline with GSe, -1% qoq/ +5% yoy.** Loan growth on a constant currency basis was +2%qoq / +3% yoy, underpinned by +3% qoq growth in non-trade corporate loans, stable consumer loans and mortgages, offsetting the decline in trade loans.

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- **NIM -3bps qoq to 2.12% vs GSe of 2.11%**, as higher market trading income partly offsets the 9bps qoq decline in commercial book NIM.
- **Non-interest income was 9% above GSe**, +26% qoq /+8% yoy. Fees and commission income was up 32% qoq / 22% yoy, driven by wealth management on the back of higher investment product sales, and loan-related fees due to increased market activities. Other non-interest income increased 17% qoq from strong trading income.
- **NPL ratio was flattish at 1.1%** with new NPL formation lower qoq on IBG book and lower NPA at CBG book.
- **Credit cost came in at 30bps**, higher than GSe of 20bps, including 10bps of SP and 20bps of GP as a prudent measure to strengthen reserves. LLR increased to 137% from 129% at 4Q24.
- **Expenses were +6% yoy/ -8% qoq, inline with GSe**. Expenses were well-managed with cost to income ratio (CIR) for the quarter at 37.5%, flattish vs. 1Q24's 37.4%.

Our 12-month target price (2-staged DDM-based) for DBS is S\$49.80. Key risks: (-) Unexpected acceleration in rate cuts; (-) Unexpected asset quality deterioration; (-) Mismanaged top management transition. Remain Buy.

Exhibit 1: 1Q25 earnings summary

Income statement (\$mn)	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	1Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Net Interest Income	3,505	3,594	3,597	3,728	3,681	5	(1)	3,725	(1)
Fee & Commission	1,043	1,048	1,109	968	1,275	22	32	1,192	7
Other Non-Interest Income	1,009	840	1,047	809	949	(6)	17	850	12
Non-Interest Income	2,052	1,888	2,156	1,777	2,224	8	25	2,042	9
Operating Income	5,557	5,482	5,753	5,505	5,905	6	7	5,767	2
Operating Expenses	(2,079)	(2,172)	(2,249)	(2,395)	(2,214)	6	(8)	(2,266)	(2)
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	3,478	3,310	3,504	3,110	3,691	6	19	3,501	5
Loan Loss Provisions	(135)	(148)	(130)	(209)	(325)	141	56	(219)	48
Pre-tax Profit	3,394	3,213	3,440	2,960	3,437	1	16	3,347	3
Net Profit	2,951	2,789	3,027	2,523	2,897	(2)	15	2,828	2
Core Net Profit	2,951	2,808	3,027	2,623	2,897	(2)	10	2,828	2

Balance sheet (\$mn)	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	1Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Assets	783,208	790,111	789,609	827,219	840,823	7	2	832,549	1
Gross Loans	431,000	430,912	424,000	436,684	442,000	2.6	1.2	438,815	1
Non-Performing Loans	4,741	4,754	4,240	4,780	4,862	3	2	4,858	0
Customer Deposits	547,197	551,088	544,961	561,730	575,663	5	2	565,972	2

CAMEL Ratios (%)	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	1Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Core Tier 1	14.7	14.8	15.2	15.1	15.2			15.2	
NPL Ratio	1.10	1.10	1.00	1.09	1.10			1.11	
Loan Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	13	14	12	19	30			20	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.14	2.14	2.11	2.15	2.12			2.11	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	37.4	39.6	39.1	43.5	37.5			39.3	
Loan-to-Deposits	78.8	78.2	77.8	77.7	76.8			77.5	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

DBSM.SI	12m Price Target: S\$49.80	Price: S\$42.76	Upside: 16.5%			
Buy	GS Forecast					
	Market cap: S\$120.7bn / \$93.6bn	Net inc. (S\$ mn)	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
	3m ADTV: S\$265.8mn / \$199.3mn	EPS (S\$)	11,409.0	10,380.5	10,484.8	10,986.7
	Singapore	EPS growth (%)	4.01	3.68	3.75	3.95
	Asean Financials	P/E (X)	10.9	(8.2)	1.8	5.6
	M&A Rank: 3	P/B (X)	8.9	11.6	11.4	10.8
		ROA (%)	1.5	1.8	1.8	1.7
		ROE (%)	1.5	1.2	1.2	1.3
		Price/PPOP (X)	18.1	15.5	15.4	16.1
		Dividend yield (%)	9.0	9.3	9.2	8.8
			6.2	7.2	7.7	8.3
			12/24	3/25E	6/25E	9/25E
	EPS (S\$)	0.89	0.99	0.87	0.95	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 7 May 2025 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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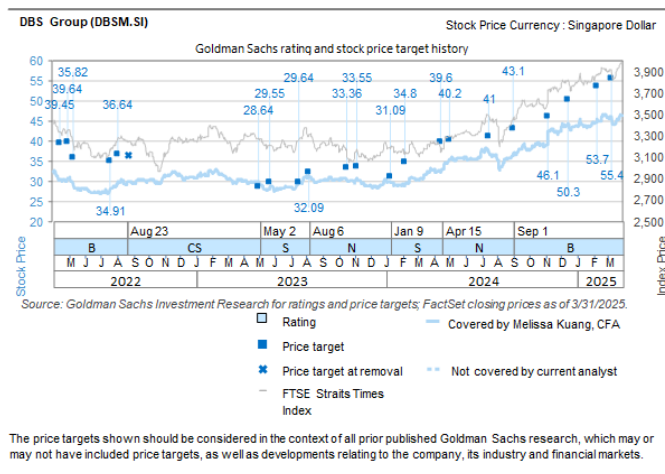
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



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